presidency in 2008. Ratan on his part focused on helping in the nation's economic development. Among the many steps he took in the direction was to make South Africa the hub of Tata's operations in the African continent.

Two years before he stepped down as chairman, Tata Sons, Ratan was appointed as one of the two chairs of the India–South Africa CEO Forum to India. His international recognitions continued. He was chosen to be a part of the 'Clinton Global Initiatives 2010 Annual Meeting'; that brought 'together global leaders from all sectors of society to develop and then implement workable solutions to some of the world's most pressing issues'. For his 'outstanding contribution to strengthening and developing the economic relation between Japan and India', he was honoured with the Grand Cordon of the Order of the Rising Sun by the emperor of Japan in 2012.

In 2013, Ratan was inducted into the board of trustees of the Carnegie Endowment for International Peace. Harvey V. Fineberg, chairman of the board, said that Ratan 'has an unparalleled knowledge of the global economy' and business in 'one of the world's most important emerging economies' as well as 'enormous experience managing large organizations', which makes him a 'tremendous asset for Carnegie'.

Some of the qualities that the world admires in Ratan took roots or were influenced by his admiration or association with some of the iconic personalities of the world. Besides his mentor JRD, John F. Kennedy, Professor Amar Bose and Jean Riboud, CEO and chairman of Schlumberger, influenced Ratan in many ways. Of JRD, he said: 'One very important person who shaped the way I think is JRD Tata, who I worked with in varying degrees of closeness.' Though he never met US President Kennedy, Ratan said: 'I never met him but his thinking influenced me in many ways.' What made them great influencers were their 'strong values'. 'They have integrity of a high order and a very forceful social consciousness [and as regards industrial leaders] in terms of what their corporations do. In addition, they are warm, thoughtful and caring human beings', says Ratan.

Speaking about Bose, whom he knew well for 'many years' and 'shared many things with', he said that the professor was a 'person with high ideals and a strong value system'. With Riboud, Ratan says that he had a 'close personal relationship'. They were bonded by a special kinship. Born in the same year as his mother, Riboud treated him like a son, recalls Ratan.